Computer Networks · Project Documentation

Video Conferencing Application (Mini-Meet)

Project number	16
Project title	Video Conferencing Application (Mini-Meet) Group B: Real-World Application Projects
Team members	Suvansh Choudhary (25BAI0252) Priyam Sharma (25BAI0159) Avika Agarwal (25BBS0057)
Source code	https://github.com/TowVansh/mini-meet

Expected outcomes and status

No.	Expected outcome	Status
1	Working multi-party call with audio and video	**Done**
2	Custom signalling server and documented signalling protocol	**Done**
3	NAT traversal demonstration across separate networks (STUN)	**Done**
4	Call-quality measurements under packet loss, jitter and bandwidth limits	**Done**
5	Architecture document covering media path vs. signalling path	**Done**

Outcome 1: Working multi-party call with audio and video **Done**

Each client captures from the webcam and microphone, encodes VP8 video and Opus audio, and sends RTP packets over UDP directly to every other participant (full mesh, up to 4 people). Each video frame is split into packets that fit the MTU, and each packet is copied to every connected peer.

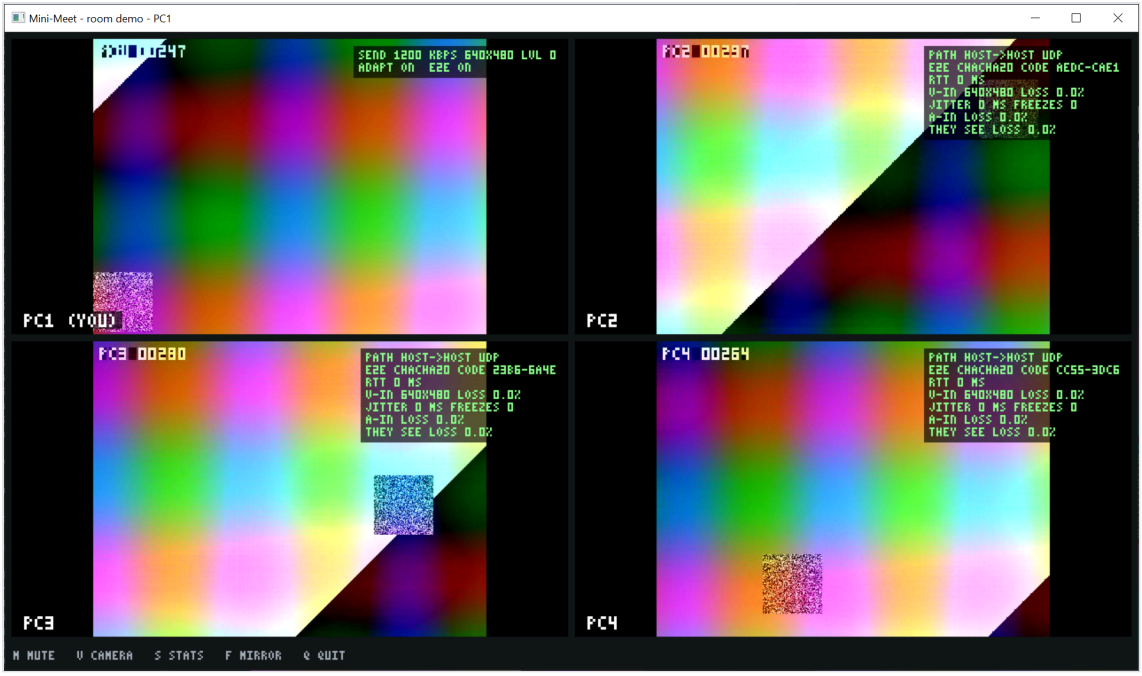
Code

src/client/media_in.c

```
static void fanout(const uint8_t *pkt, size_t len, int video) {
    int i;
    for (i = 0; i < MAX_PEERS; i++) {
        peer_t *p = &g.peers[i];
        if (!media_ready(p)) continue;
        send_rtp_to(p, pkt, len);
        if (video) p->tx_bytes_v += len;
        else p->tx_bytes_a += len;
    }
}

void send_video_frame(const uint8_t *data, size_t len, int key, uint32_t ts) {
    const size_t chunk = RTP_MAX_PAYLOAD - 1;
    size_t off = 0;
    SDL_LockMutex(g.lock);
    while (off < len) {
        uint8_t pkt[PKT_MAX];
        size_t n = len - off < chunk ? len - off : chunk, plen;
        rtp_hdr_t h;
        h.marker = off + n >= len;          /* marker = last packet of this frame */
        h.pt = RTP_PT_VP8;
        h.seq = g.vseq++;
        h.ts = ts;
        h.ssrc = g.vssrc;
        plen = rtp_write_header(pkt, &h);
        pkt[plen++] = (uint8_t)((off == 0 ? VP_START : 0) | (key ? VP_KEY : 0));
        memcpy(pkt + plen, data + off, n);
        plen += n;
        {   /* keep a copy for NACK retransmission */
            int slot = h.seq % TX_HISTORY;
            g.txhist[slot].used = 1;
            g.txhist[slot].seq = h.seq;
            g.txhist[slot].len = (uint16_t)plen;
            g.txhist[slot].sent_us = now_us();
            memcpy(g.txhist[slot].data, pkt, plen);
        }
        fanout(pkt, plen, 1);
        g.vpackets++;
        g.voctets += (uint32_t)n;
        off += n;
    }
    g.last_vts = ts;
    SDL_UnlockMutex(g.lock);
}
```

Implementation



Four clients in one call, seen from PC1, using the built-in test video and tone. Each remote tile shows its live statistics.

All 12 directed video streams of a 4-person call arrived at 640×480 and 20 fps, about 1190–1220 kbps each. The webcam and microphone call is shown live in the demo.

Outcome 2: Custom signalling server and documented signalling protocol Done

`mm-server` is a single-threaded `select()` server. It groups clients into rooms of up to 4 and relays network candidates and public keys inside a room. Every message is one line of text over TCP. The full protocol is documented in `docs/PROTOCOL.md`.

Client to server	Server to client
`JOIN <room> <name>`	`JOINED <id> <room> [id:name ...]`
`CAND <to> <type> <ip> <port>`	`PEER_JOINED <id> <name>`, `PEER_LEFT <id>`
`KEY <to> <64 hex>`	`CAND <from> ...`, `KEY <from> ...`
`LEAVE`, `PING`	`PONG`, `ERROR <code> <text>`

Code

src/server/mm_server.c

```
static void handle_join(client_t *c, mm_msg_t *m) {
    char line[MM_LINE_MAX];
    size_t len;
    int i;
    if (m->argc != 3) return send_error(c, "BAD_MESSAGE", "usage: JOIN <room> <name>");
    if (c->room[0]) return send_error(c, "ALREADY_JOINED", "already in a room");
    if (!mm_valid_name(m->argv[1]) || !mm_valid_name(m->argv[2]))
        return send_error(c, "BAD_NAME", "room and name must be 1-32 chars of A-Z a-z 0-9 _ -");
    if (room_count(m->argv[1]) >= MM_MAX_ROOM) return send_error(c, "ROOM_FULL", "room already has 4
participants");

    snprintf(c->name, sizeof c->name, "%s", m->argv[2]);
    snprintf(c->room, sizeof c->room, "%s", m->argv[1]);

    /* JOINED lists everyone already in the room; they get PEER_JOINED. */
    len = (size_t)snprintf(line, sizeof line, "JOINED %s %s", c->id, c->room);
    for (i = 0; i < nclients; i++) {
        client_t *o = &clients[i];
        if (o == c || strcmp(o->room, c->room) != 0) continue;
        len += (size_t)snprintf(line + len, sizeof line - len, " %s:%s", o->id, o->name);
        send_line(o, "PEER_JOINED %s %s", c->id, c->name);
    }
    send_line(c, "%s", line);
    {
        char a[32];
        log_msg("room", "join room=%s id=%s name=%s from=%s (%d/%d)", c->room, c->id, c->name,
                ep_str(&c->addr, a, sizeof a), room_count(c->room), MM_MAX_ROOM);
    }
}

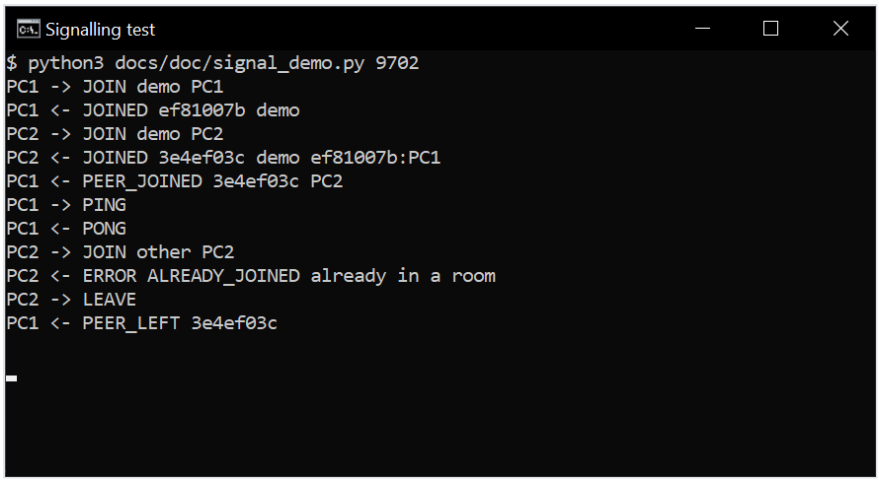
static void handle_cand(client_t *c, mm_msg_t *m) {
    client_t *to;
    endpoint_t ep;
    if (m->argc != 5) return send_error(c, "BAD_MESSAGE", "usage: CAND <to> <type> <ip> <port>");
    if (!c->room[0]) return send_error(c, "NOT_JOINED", "join a room first");
    if (!mm_valid_cand_type(m->argv[2]) || ep_parse(m->argv[3], m->argv[4], &ep) != 0)
        return send_error(c, "BAD_MESSAGE", "bad candidate");
    to = find_in_room(c->room, m->argv[1]);
    if (!to) return send_error(c, "UNKNOWN_PEER", "target peer is not in your room");
    /* Relay with the sender's id in place of the target's. */
    send_line(to, "CAND %s %s %s %s", c->id, m->argv[2], m->argv[3], m->argv[4]);
}
```

src/common/proto.c

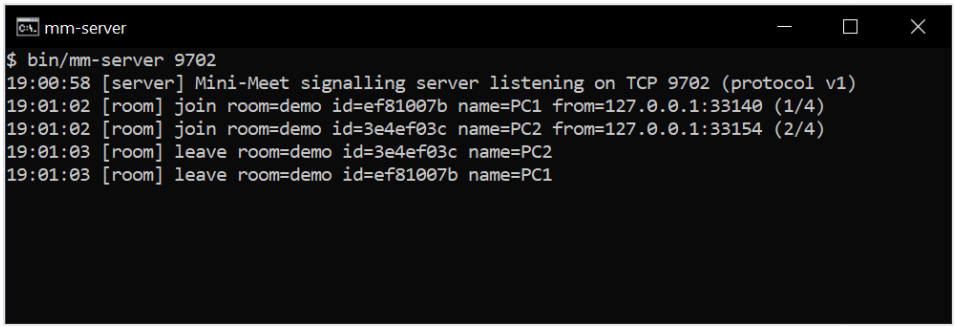
```
int mm_linebuf_pop(mm_linebuf_t *lb, char *out, size_t cap) {
    char *nl = memchr(lb->buf, '\n', lb->len);
    size_t line_len;
    if (!nl) return 0;
    line_len = (size_t)(nl - lb->buf);
```

```
    if (line_len >= cap) line_len = cap - 1;
    memcpy(out, lb->buf, line_len);
    out[line_len] = '\0';
    line_len = (size_t)(nl - lb->buf) + 1;
    memmove(lb->buf, lb->buf + line_len, lb->len - line_len);
    lb->len -= line_len;
    return 1;
}
```

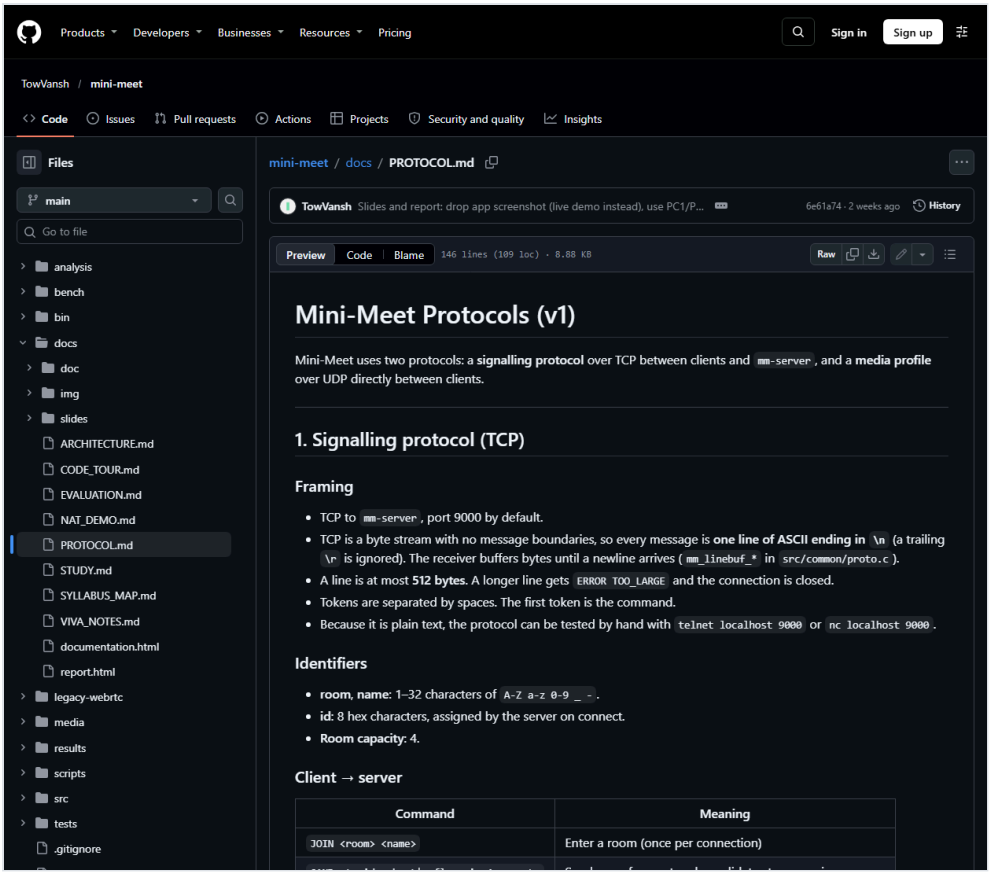
Implementation



Protocol exchange with the running server: two clients join, ping, a rejected second JOIN, and a leave.



Server log for the same session.



The protocol document, docs/PROTOCOL.md, in the repository.

Outcome 3: NAT traversal demonstration across separate networks (STUN) Done

Each client asks a STUN server for its public address (the server-reflexive, or srflx, candidate) and sends its candidates through signalling. Both peers then send STUN checks to each other at the same time, which opens a path through both NATs (UDP hole punching). The first candidate that answers carries the media.

Code

src/stun/stun.c

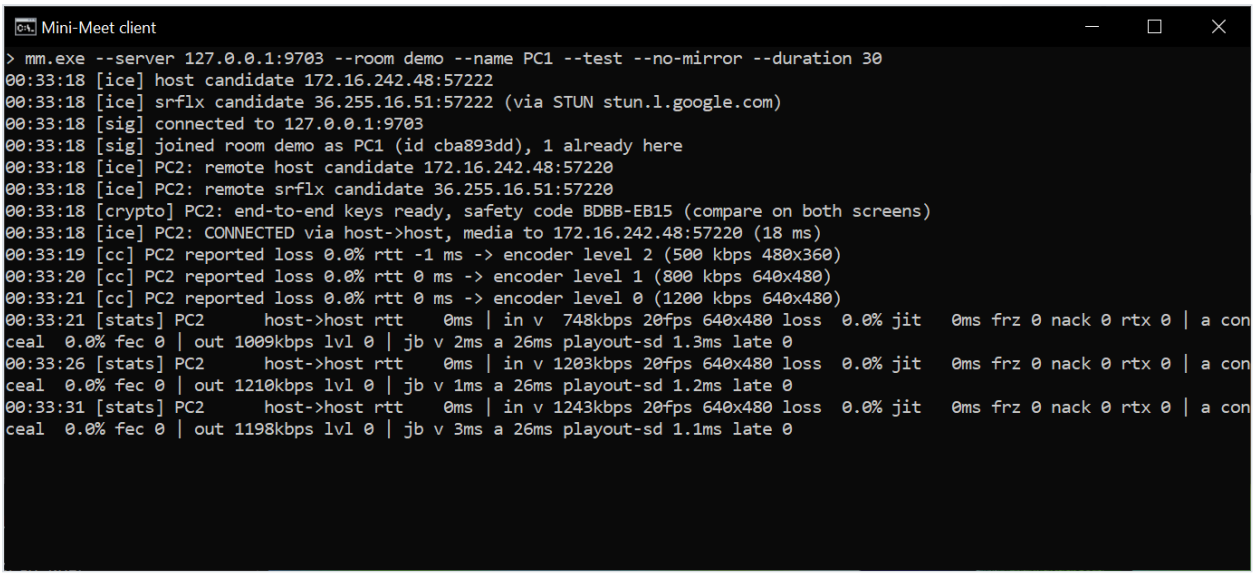
```
size_t stun_build_success(uint8_t *out, size_t cap, const uint8_t tid[12], const endpoint_t *mapped) {
    uint8_t v[8];
    uint32_t ip_host = ntohl(mapped->ip);
    size_t n;
    if (cap < STUN_HEADER_LEN) return 0;
    n = put_header(out, STUN_BINDING_SUCCESS, tid);
    /* XOR-MAPPED-ADDRESS: port XOR top 16 bits of cookie, address XOR cookie.
     * Obfuscating it stops NAT "helpers" that rewrite IPs inside payloads. */
    v[0] = 0;
    v[1] = 0x01; /* IPv4 */
    put_u16(v + 2, (uint16_t)(mapped->port ^ (STUN_MAGIC_COOKIE >> 16)));
    put_u32(v + 4, ip_host ^ STUN_MAGIC_COOKIE);
    n = put_attr(out, n, cap, STUN_ATTR_XOR_MAPPED_ADDRESS, v, 8);
    n = put_attr(out, n, cap, STUN_ATTR_SOFTWARE, "mini-meet", 9);
    finish(out, n);
    return n;
}
```

src/client/ice.c

```
static void send_check(peer_t *p, cand_t *c) {
    uint8_t buf[128];
    char user[2 * MM_ID_LEN + 2];
    snprintf(user, sizeof user, "%s:%s", p->id, g.self_id);
    udp_send(g.udp, &c->addr, buf, stun_build_request(buf, sizeof buf, c->tid, user));
}

void ice_tick(peer_t *p, uint64_t now) {
    int i;
    if (p->ice_state == ICE_CHECKING) {
        if (now - p->last_check_ms >= CHECK_INTERVAL_MS) {
            p->last_check_ms = now;
            for (i = 0; i < p->ncands; i++) send_check(p, &p->cands[i]);
        }
        if (now - p->ice_start_ms > ICE_TIMEOUT_MS) {
            p->ice_state = ICE_FAILED;
            log_msg("ice", "%s: no candidate pair worked after %d s. Both sides behind symmetric NAT? "
                    "That case needs a TURN relay.", p->name, ICE_TIMEOUT_MS / 1000);
        }
    } else if (p->ice_state == ICE_CONNECTED) {
        /* Keepalive: refresh NAT mappings (they expire after ~30 s of silence). */
        if (now - p->last_keepalive_ms >= KEEPALIVE_MS) {
            cand_t c;
            p->last_keepalive_ms = now;
            c.addr = p->sel;
            stun_new_tid(c.tid);
            send_check(p, &c);
        }
    }
}
```

Implementation



Windows client run live: STUN returns the public (srflx) address of this laptop. In this run both clients are on one laptop, so the direct host path connects first.



Saved client log of the cross-network test on 2026-10-08: this laptop on college Wi-Fi, the other (Friend) on a phone hotspot. Different private and public addresses; connected directly, srflx to srflx. The second command counts the path recorded in every sample of that call.

The test recorded 1404 samples (`results/nat_c__Laptop.csv`), all on `srflx->srflx`, with a median round-trip time of 85 ms. Signalling went through a TCP tunnel; media went directly between the laptops. Not covered: two symmetric NATs would need a TURN relay, which is not implemented. The client detects this case and reports it after 15 s.

Outcome 4: Call-quality measurements under packet loss, jitter and bandwidth limits **Done**

Two Linux network namespaces joined by a virtual link act as two hosts, with `tc netem` impairing each direction. Each of 14 profiles ran with rate control off and on (28 runs). Every client records bitrate, fps, loss, jitter, round-trip time, freezes and audio concealment each second. The full analysis is in `docs/EVALUATION.md`.

Condition	Rate control	fps	Loss %	Round-trip ms	Freezes	Audio concealed %
No impairment	on	20	0.0	0.7	0	0.0
Packet loss 5 %	off	20	4.9	0.3	0	0.2
Packet loss 20 %	off	19	19.8	0.2	23	4.0
Jitter ±60 ms	off	20	1.7	194	4	0.2
Bandwidth 1 Mbit/s	off	15	13.6	10513	0	34.1
Bandwidth 1 Mbit/s	on	20	0.0	2.8	0	2.7
Bandwidth 500 kbit/s	off	0	39.6	19414	2	49.0
Bandwidth 500 kbit/s	on	20	0.0	9.8	0	11.7

Code

scripts/impair.sh

```
profile_args() {
  case "$1" in
    baseline)    echo "" ;;
    loss1)       echo "loss 1%" ;;
    loss5)       echo "loss 5%" ;;
    loss10)      echo "loss 10%" ;;
    loss20)      echo "loss 20%" ;;
    burst5)      echo "loss gemodel 1% 30% 70% 0.1%" ;;   # bursty (Gilbert-Elliott)
    delay100)    echo "delay 100ms" ;;
    jitter30)    echo "delay 100ms 30ms distribution normal" ;;
    jitter60)    echo "delay 100ms 60ms distribution normal" ;;
    rate2m)      echo "rate 2mbit" ;;
    rate1m)      echo "rate 1mbit" ;;
    rate500k)    echo "rate 500kbit" ;;
    rate250k)    echo "rate 250kbit" ;;
    combo)       echo "delay 80ms 20ms distribution normal loss 3% rate 1mbit" ;;
    *)           return 1 ;;
  esac
}
```

src/client/rtp.c

```
void rx_stats_update(rx_stats_t *s, uint16_t seq, uint32_t rtp_ts, uint64_t arrival_us) {
    uint16_t delta = (uint16_t)(seq - s->max_seq);
    int64_t arrival, transit, d;

    /* Sequence tracking: a forward jump extends max_seq (counting wraps). */
    if (delta > 0 && delta < 3000) {
        if (seq < s->max_seq) s->cycles += 65536;
        s->max_seq = seq;
    } else if (delta > 65536 - 100 || delta == 0) {
        /* duplicate or reordered packet: counted as received below */
    } else {
        /* huge jump: the sender restarted; resync */
        s->base_seq = seq;
        s->max_seq = seq;
        s->cycles = 0;
        s->received = 0;
        s->expected_prior = s->received_prior = 0;
```

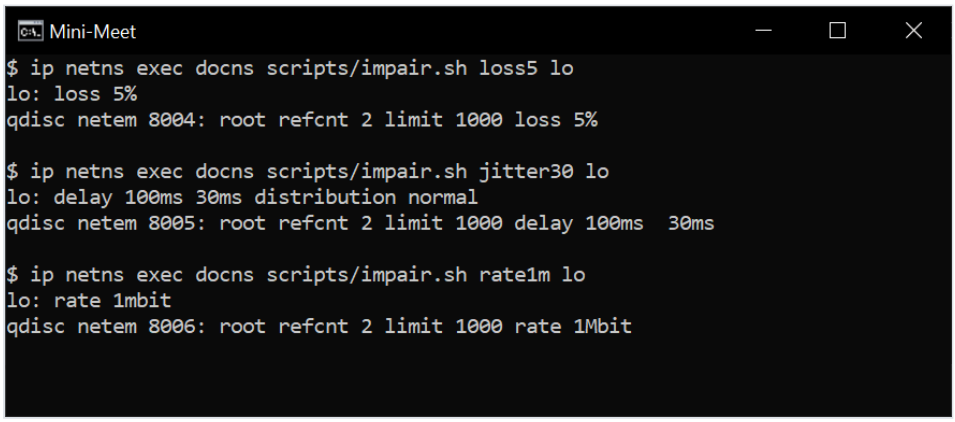
```
    }
    s->received++;

    /* Interarrival jitter, RFC 3550 6.4.1: J += (|D| - J) / 16, in RTP units. */
    arrival = (int64_t)(arrival_us * s->clock_rate / 1000000ull);
    transit = arrival - (int64_t)rtp_ts;
    if (s->have_transit) {
        d = transit - s->last_transit;
        if (d < 0) d = -d;
        s->jitter += ((double)d - s->jitter) / 16.0;
    }
    s->last_transit = transit;
    s->have_transit = 1;
}
```

src/client/cc.c

```
int cc_on_report(cc_state_t *cc, double loss, double rtt_ms) {
    int old = cc->level;
    double qdelay;
    if (rtt_ms >= 0) {
        /* Smooth out jitter in single samples (like TCP's SRTT, alpha = 1/4). */
        cc->srtt_ms = cc->srtt_ms < 0 ? rtt_ms : 0.75 * cc->srtt_ms + 0.25 * rtt_ms;
        if (cc->min_ever_ms < 0 || cc->srtt_ms < cc->min_ever_ms) cc->min_ever_ms = cc->srtt_ms;
        /* Window holds smoothed values too, so random jitter in single samples
         * does not drag the baseline down and look like queuing delay. */
        cc->rtt_hist[cc->hist_pos] = cc->srtt_ms;
        cc->hist_pos = (cc->hist_pos + 1) % CC_RTT_WINDOW;
        if (cc->nhist < CC_RTT_WINDOW) cc->nhist++;
    }
    qdelay = cc_queuing_delay(cc);
    if (loss > LOSS_BAD || qdelay > QDELAY_BAD) {
        cc->level += 2;
        if (cc->level >= CC_LEVELS) cc->level = CC_LEVELS - 1;
        cc->clean = 0;
        cc->startup = 0;
    } else if (loss < LOSS_OK && qdelay < QDELAY_OK) {
        /* Startup: climb one level per clean report until the first congestion
         * signal (fast ramp like TCP slow start), then the slower AIMD rule. */
        if (++cc->clean >= (cc->startup ? 1 : CLEAN_ROUNDS)) {
            if (cc->level > 0) cc->level--;
            cc->clean = 0;
        }
    } else {
        cc->clean = 0;
    }
    return cc->level != old;
}
```

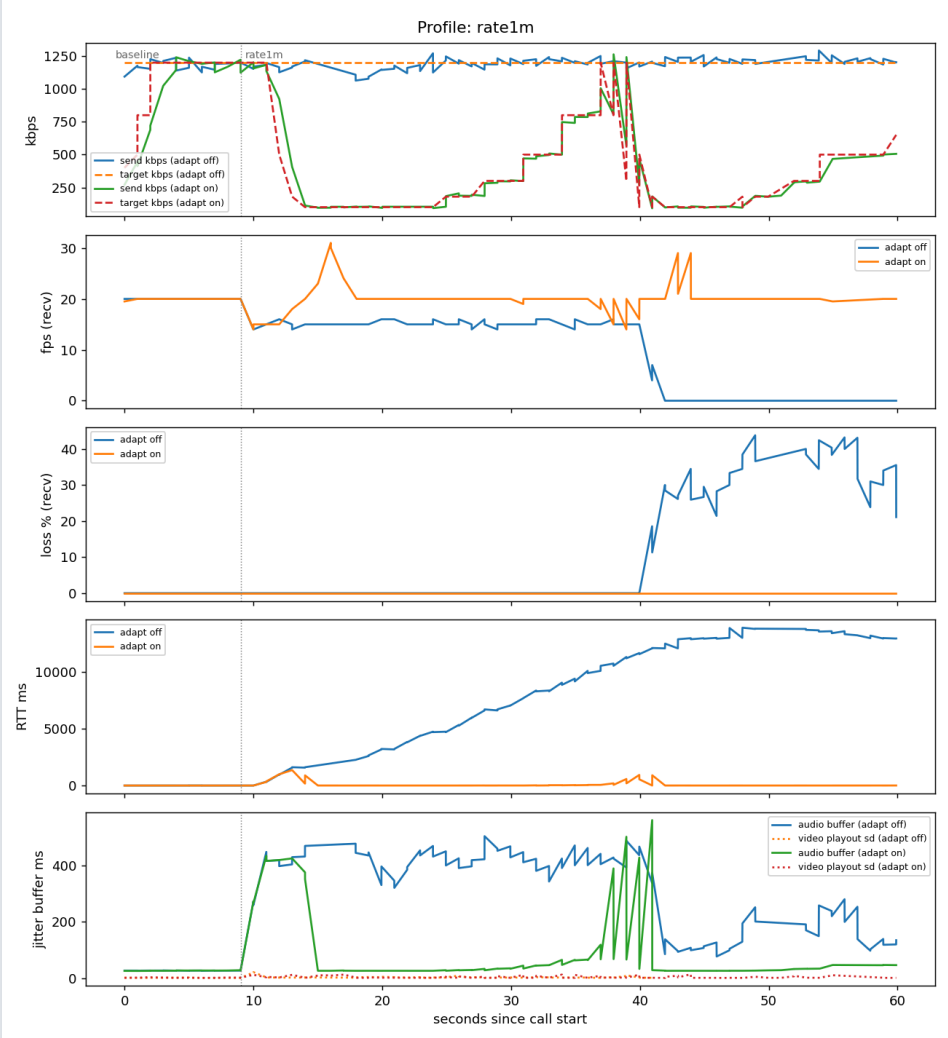
Implementation



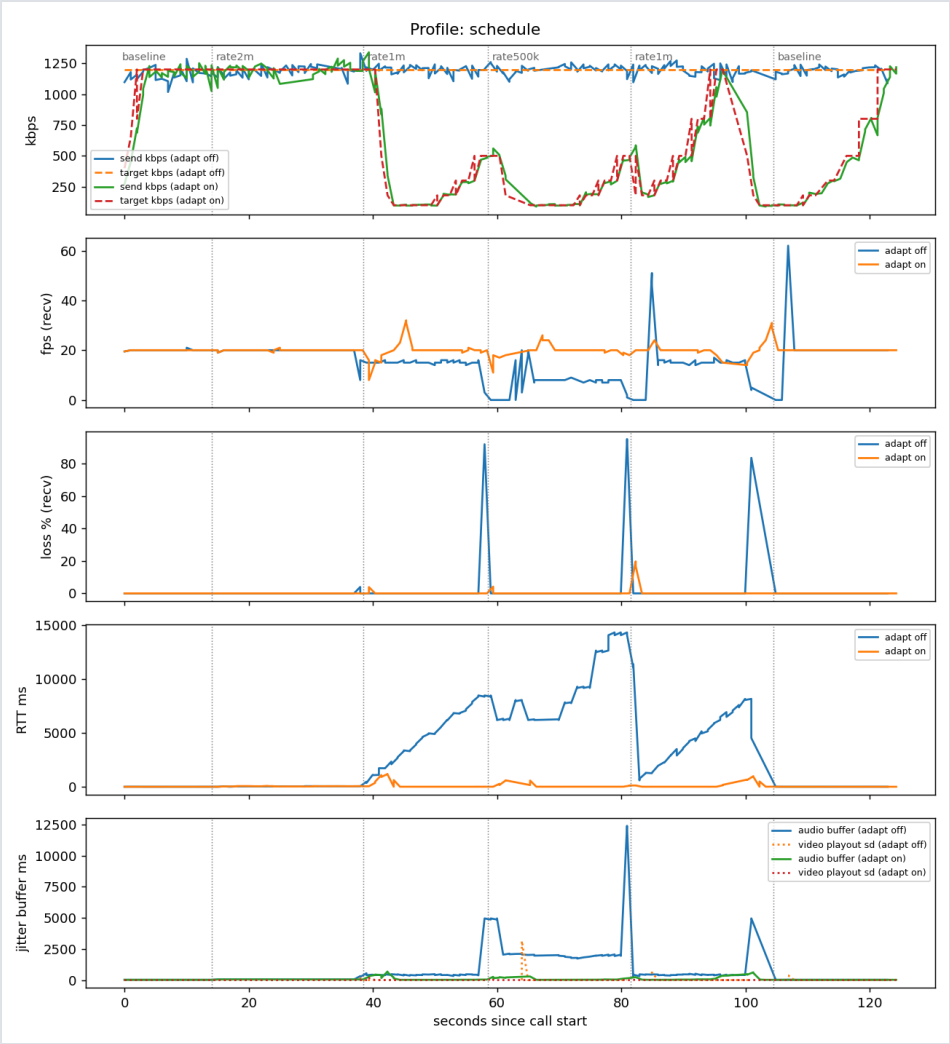
Impairment profiles applied with tc netem.

```
Mini-Meet
$ grep 'cc\]' results/eval_rate1m_adapt1_p2__botA.log | cut -c1-90 | head -12
16:48:14 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt -1 ms -> encoder level 2 (500 kbps 480x360)
16:48:15 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 0 ms -> encoder level 1 (800 kbps 640x480)
16:48:16 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 0 ms -> encoder level 0 (1200 kbps 640x480)
16:48:25 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 997 ms -> encoder level 2 (500 kbps 480x360)
16:48:27 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 1390 ms -> encoder level 4 (180 kbps 320x240)
16:48:27 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 897 ms -> encoder level 5 (100 kbps 160x120)
16:48:39 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 3 ms -> encoder level 4 (180 kbps 320x240)
16:48:42 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 6 ms -> encoder level 3 (300 kbps 320x240)
16:48:45 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 15 ms -> encoder level 2 (500 kbps 480x360)
16:48:48 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 38 ms -> encoder level 1 (800 kbps 640x480)
16:48:52 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 576 ms -> encoder level 3 (300 kbps 320x240)
16:48:54 [cc] botB reported loss 0.0% rtt 934 ms -> encoder level 5 (100 kbps 160x120)
```

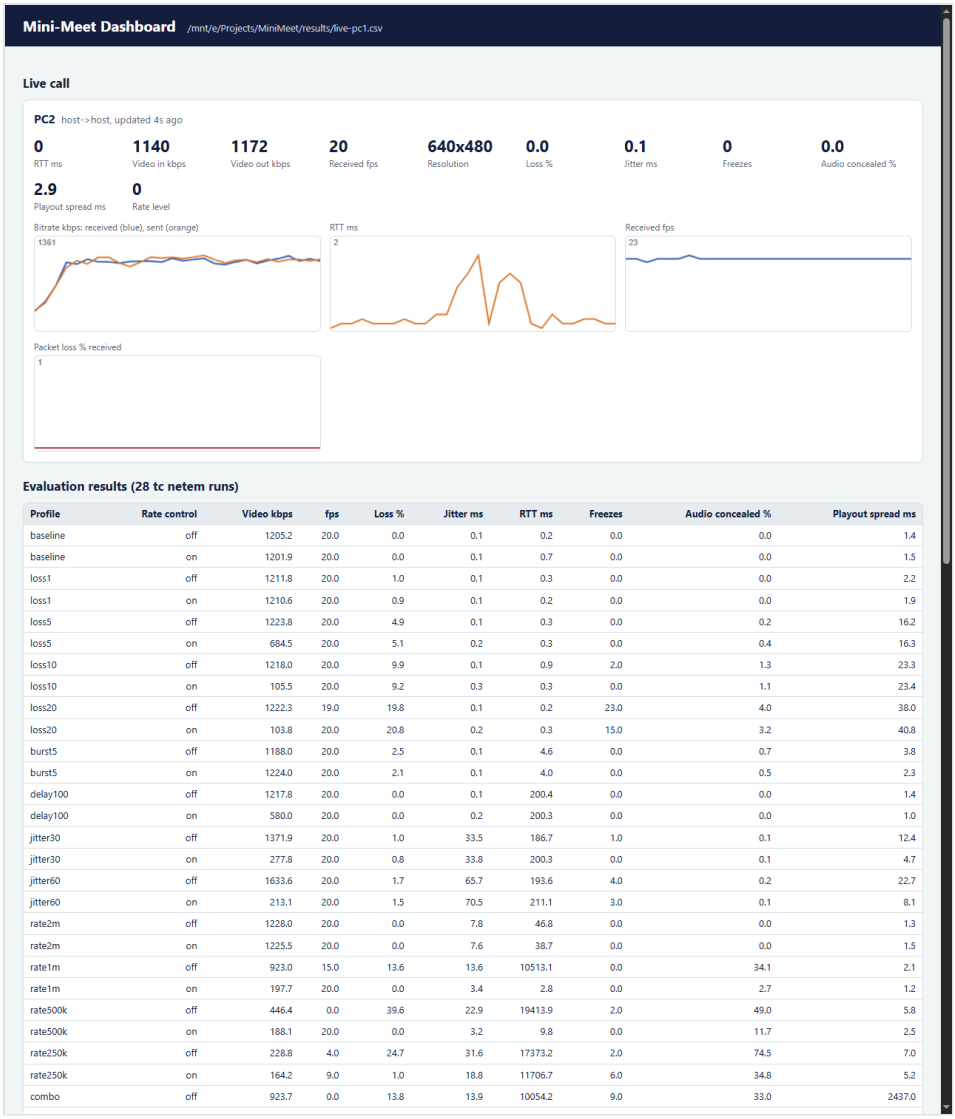
Rate controller log during the 1 Mbit/s run: it backs off when the round-trip time rises, then climbs again.



1 Mbit/s cap applied at 9 s. Fixed rate (blue): the round-trip time climbs past 10 s and loss reaches 13.6 %. With rate control: the call stays at 20 fps.



One call through changing bandwidth: clean, 2 Mbit/s, 1 Mbit/s, 500 kbit/s, 1 Mbit/s, clean.



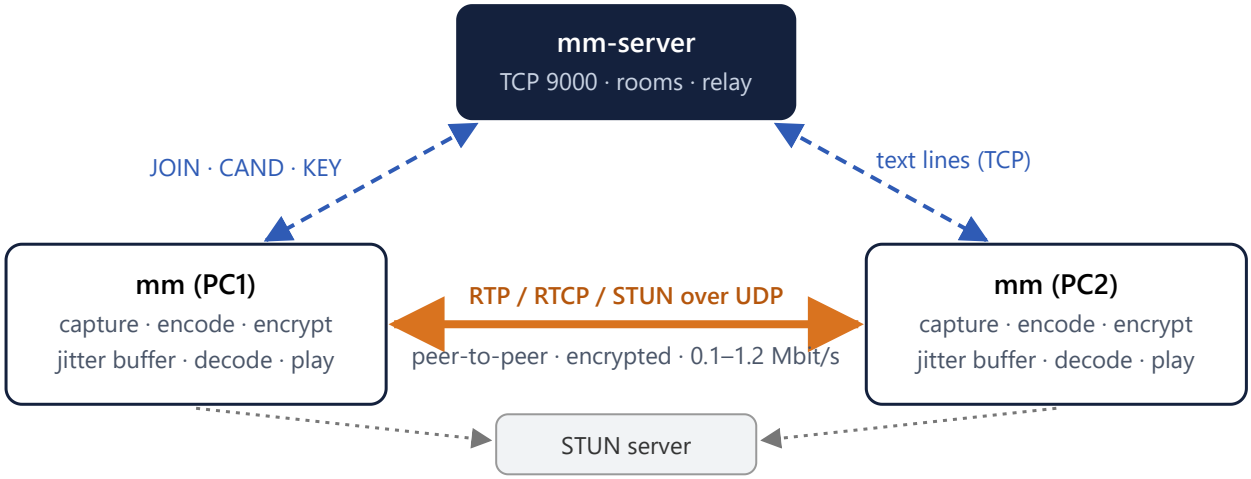
Evaluation results (28 tc netem runs)

Profile	Rate control	Video kbps	fps	Loss %	Jitter ms	RTT ms	Freezes	Audio concealed %	Playout spread ms
baseline	off	1205.2	20.0	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.0	1.4
baseline	on	1201.9	20.0	0.0	0.1	0.7	0.0	0.0	1.5
loss1	off	1211.8	20.0	1.0	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.0	2.2
loss1	on	1210.6	20.0	0.9	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.0	1.9
loss5	off	1223.8	20.0	4.9	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.2	16.2
loss5	on	684.5	20.0	5.1	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.4	16.3
loss10	off	1218.0	20.0	9.9	0.1	0.9	2.0	1.3	23.3
loss10	on	105.5	20.0	9.2	0.3	0.3	0.0	1.1	23.4
loss20	off	1222.3	19.0	19.8	0.1	0.2	23.0	4.0	38.0
loss20	on	103.8	20.0	20.8	0.2	0.3	15.0	3.2	40.8
burst5	off	1188.0	20.0	2.5	0.1	4.6	0.0	0.7	3.8
burst5	on	1224.0	20.0	2.1	0.1	4.0	0.0	0.5	2.3
delay100	off	1217.8	20.0	0.0	0.1	200.4	0.0	0.0	1.4
delay100	on	580.0	20.0	0.0	0.2	200.3	0.0	0.0	1.0
jitter30	off	1371.9	20.0	1.0	33.5	186.7	1.0	0.1	12.4
jitter30	on	277.8	20.0	0.8	33.8	200.3	0.0	0.1	4.7
jitter60	off	1633.6	20.0	1.7	65.7	193.6	4.0	0.2	22.7
jitter60	on	213.1	20.0	1.5	70.5	211.1	3.0	0.1	8.1
rate2m	off	1228.0	20.0	0.0	7.8	46.8	0.0	0.0	1.3
rate2m	on	1225.5	20.0	0.0	7.6	38.7	0.0	0.0	1.5
rate1m	off	923.0	15.0	13.6	13.6	10513.1	0.0	34.1	2.1
rate1m	on	197.7	20.0	0.0	3.4	2.8	0.0	2.7	1.2
rate500k	off	446.4	0.0	39.6	22.9	19413.9	2.0	49.0	5.8
rate500k	on	188.1	20.0	0.0	3.2	9.8	0.0	11.7	2.5
rate250k	off	228.8	4.0	24.7	31.6	17373.2	2.0	74.5	7.0
rate250k	on	164.2	9.0	1.0	18.8	11706.7	6.0	34.8	5.2
combo	off	923.7	0.0	13.8	13.9	10054.2	9.0	33.0	2437.0

Dashboard (analysis/dashboard.py): live statistics of a running call, above the evaluation results.

Outcome 5: Architecture document covering media path vs. signalling path Done

The full architecture document is `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md` in the repository. In short, signalling goes through the server over TCP, and media goes directly between peers over UDP.



Signalling path (dashed, TCP) and media path (solid, UDP).

	Signalling path	Media path
Purpose	Find peers, exchange network candidates and public keys	Carry audio and video
Endpoints	Client to `mm-server`	Client to client (full mesh)
Transport	TCP, one text line per message	UDP: RTP, RTCP and STUN on one port
Volume	A few hundred bytes per call setup	0.1–1.2 Mbit/s per stream
If the server stops	New joins fail	Running calls continue

Code

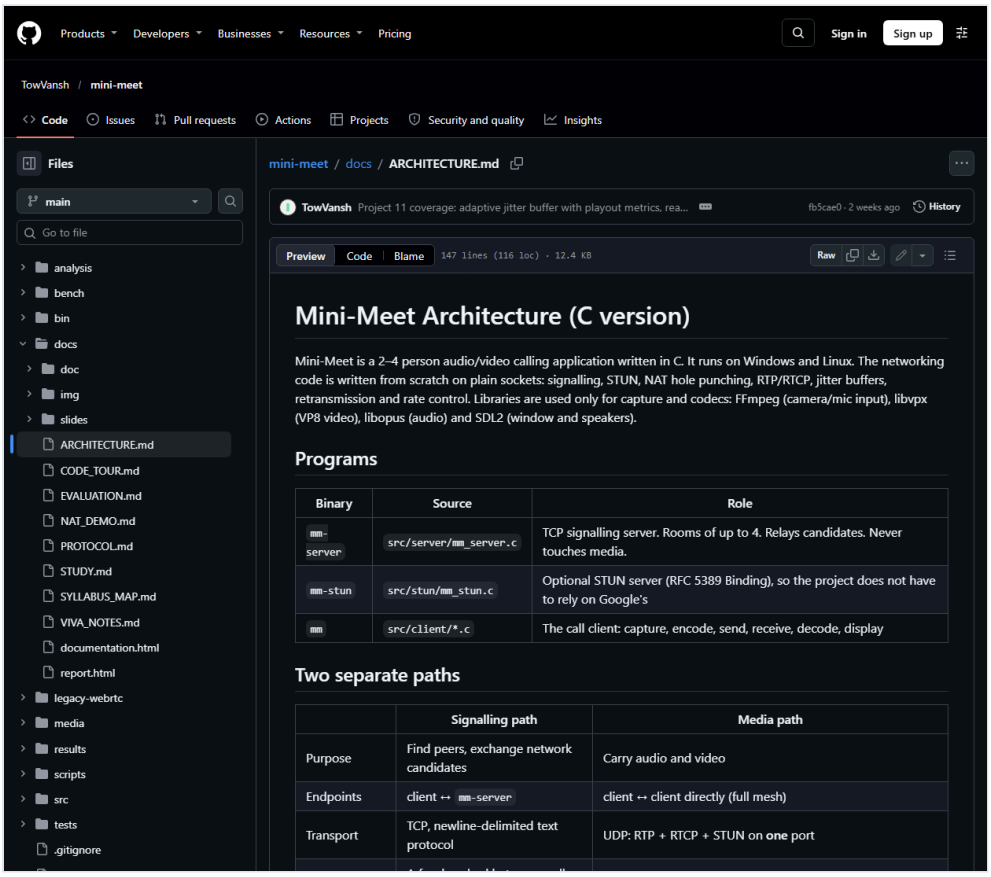
Where the two paths meet in the client: one `select()` loop watches the TCP signalling socket and the UDP media socket, and each UDP packet is sorted into STUN, RTCP or RTP by its first bytes.

`src/client/netloop.c`

```
static void on_udp(uint8_t *buf, size_t len, const endpoint_t *from, uint64_t now_us) {
    peer_t *p;
    rtp_hdr_t h;
    int off;
    size_t wire_len = len;
    /* Demultiplex by first byte (RFC 7983): 0-3 STUN, 128-191 RTP/RTCP. */
    if (stun_is_stun(buf, len)) {
        ice_on_stun(buf, len, from);
        return;
    }
    p = peer_by_addr(from);
    if (!p) return;
    p->last_rx_ms = now_us / 1000;
    if (rtp_is_rtcp(buf, len)) {
        if (g.encrypt && (!p->crypto.ready || !(len = mmc_open_rtcp(&p->crypto, buf, len)))) {
            p->bad_auth++;
            return;
        }
        on_rtcp(p, buf, len, now_us);
        return;
    }
    /* Decrypt and verify before anything else trusts the packet. */
    if (g.encrypt && (!p->crypto.ready || !(len = mmc_open_rtp(&p->crypto, buf, len)))) {
        p->bad_auth++;
```

```
        return;
    }
    off = rtp_parse_header(buf, len, &h);
    if (off < 0) return;
    /* bitrate counts bytes as they were on the wire (including the auth tag) */
    if (h.pt == RTP_PT_VP8 || h.pt == RTP_PT_VP8_RTX) {
        p->rx_bytes_v += wire_len;
        rx_video(p, &h, buf + off, len - (size_t)off, h.pt == RTP_PT_VP8_RTX, now_us);
    } else if (h.pt == RTP_PT_OPUS) {
        p->rx_bytes_a += wire_len;
        rx_audio(p, &h, buf + off, len - (size_t)off, now_us);
    }
}
```

Implementation



The architecture document, docs/ARCHITECTURE.md, in the repository.



Unit tests covering the protocol code on both paths.